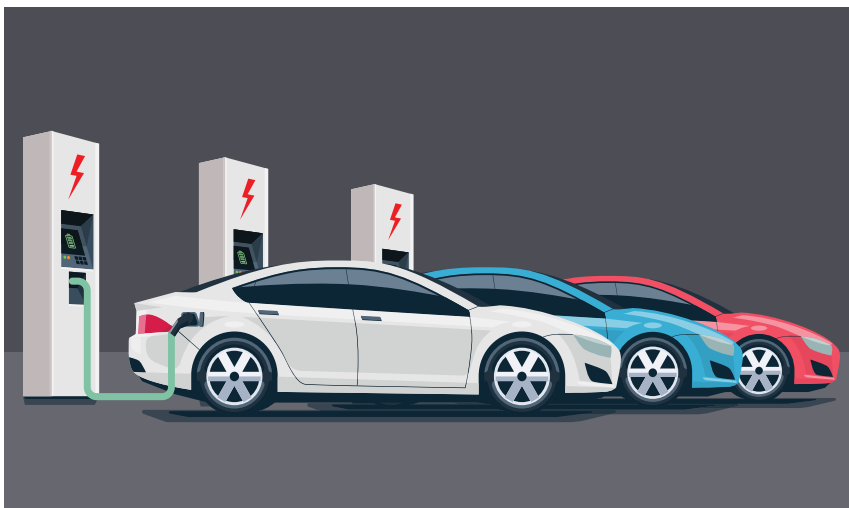




Charging infrastructure, or the lack thereof, is currently seen as the biggest hurdle to EV adoption

while heralding the clean mobility millennium in the subcontinent?

Look away from the electric 4-wheeler

The roads, climate conditions, traffic management, and even the way owners handle their vehicles in India are incomparable to the developed nations, which have set similar goals like India's but seem far more doable.

That is not to say that Indian OEMs have lagged behind in the race. The automobile industry has always been a game that the Indian businesses have been able to massively cash in on. So, it is evident that interested parties who have recognised the inevitability of the shift to electric mobility would expect to rake similar points here as well.

As per a report by the World Economic Forum (WEF), India made up only 0.5% of the global EV market in 2018. The numbers need to increase massively to meet the expectations of the behemoth target of 30% EVs in the country, and for that OEMs have to put in the work.

The world has been watching closely the developments in the space and already has big players, in the form of renowned OEMs, working in the field to help them get a head start. To beat them, India

needs to build the same level of expertise and resourcefulness. For that, it needs to choose the target segment wisely.

Here's the catch. While most countries have focused on the 4-wheeler segment, the 2-wheeler segment in EV market has been left virtually untouched. Experts have concluded that the 2- and 3-wheeler segments are where India can capitalise on.

The 2-wheeler market, which has been a thriving market in the Indian automobile industry pre-EVs, is still just as much of a business opportunity, if not more. In fact, market reports suggest that 50% of India's EV goals would be met by 2-wheelers.

Interestingly, there is no one company that has taken the biggest piece of the pie yet. Yes, there are OEMs that are steadily treading the route to become a force to reckon with, but it still keeps a lot of space for newer participation.

Let business model suit the ecosystem

Over the past couple of months, various Indian OEMs have invested heavily in increasing their production capacity, some even going as far as creating the world's largest factories. But is manufacturing

the one-stop solution to our woes? There are aspects of the ecosystem that need to grow at the same pace in order to keep up with the manufacturing boom.

For starters, charging infrastructure, or the lack thereof, is currently seen as the biggest hurdle to EV adoption. Similarly, a lack of servicing support also raises doubts in the minds of consumers. Businesses need to come up with models that can eliminate these hurdles.

The various permutations and combinations of possible businesses in the EV industry know no end. It is pretty evident that the EV industry is in its infancy in India, which is precisely the perfect time to set up shop in this burgeoning sector. Be it in charging, or servicing, or support, or financing, companies can leverage any aspect of the ecosystem and emerge victorious, as long as they solve a problem.

The introduction of electric mobility is going to need some convincing to make the entire country discard their ICE vehicles for electric models, what with range anxiety and the price disparity.

The brand identity of OEMs is just as crucial of a deciding factor when converting previous ICE vehicle owners to EV owners. Brands and OEMs that have been around for a long time and have had a considerably good repo with customers definitely have an advantage over newer startups, and this is where they have to break the ice. Forming a brand identity that can convince the skeptical customer to take the plunge is going to be the biggest hurdle.

Put the tech talent to work

India has another aspect in its favour: its vast technical know-how. There is, of course, no doubt that India churns out some of the world's brightest tech minds and, in order to make electric mobility in India become a class-apart, it is